

10th September 2026

## **Invitation to tender for the provision of administrative services and events organisation for the British Crystallographic Association**

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This document, and any associated Annexes, is classified as “**COMMERCIAL IN CONFIDENCE**”. Information provided herein should be used solely for the purposes of the tender exercise and any subsequent contract for the supply of services to the British Crystallographic Association. Information should not be disclosed to third parties, other than for strictly related purposes, without prior written consent from the officers of the British Crystallographic Association.

This specification will be an integral part of any subsequent contract. The tenderer must indicate whether each individual clause is accepted and, if not, a full explanation must be provided. Where an alternative service is proposed by the tenderer, this must always be in addition to a bid that fully meets the existing specification.

Section 3.3 of this specification lists the information required with the tender. It is essential that this accompanies the tender reply. In the absence of this information, the bid may be rejected as non-compliant.

# 1. INTRODUCTION AND SCOPE

## 1.1. Introduction

The British Crystallographic Association (BCA), formed in 1982 is the UK national association for this important science. Crystallography is a vital part of much modern research into the structure and properties of materials ranging across the scientific fields of Chemistry, Biology, Physics, Materials science and Engineering.

With around 600 to 700 members, and representing the huge academic and industrial effort in crystallography in this country, the BCA has as its prime aims the promotion of crystallography in research and the education of young people and others in the methods, possibilities and achievements of crystallographic science.

The four subject based groups within the association: [biological structures](#); [chemical crystallography](#); [industrial applications](#) & [physical crystallography](#) - represent the more specialist research areas, and the interdisciplinary [Early Stage Crystallographers group](#) encourages a strong interaction and exchange of ideas among post-graduate students and members by organising regular meetings. Many meetings, workshops and schools are organised by the BCA groups, contributing to the [dissemination of crystallographic knowledge and education](#).

The BCA can award [Honorary Life Membership](#) to crystallographers who have made significant contributions to the field and to the BCA.

Many of the crystallographic pioneers worked in the UK including the Braggs - father and son - Wilkins, Perutz, Hodgkin, Franklin, Lonsdale, Kendrew & Klug. Currently, there is huge UK crystallographic activity contributing to research in virology, structural genomics, cancer research, enzymology, pharmaceuticals, superconductors, semiconductors, magnetic materials, laser materials, polymers, battery and fuel cell materials, zeolites, materials under stress and many other areas.

The BCA wishes to work with an organisation who can support our membership administration and planning and running meetings in order to meet the aims set out above.

## 1.2. Scope

The scope of this contract is to provide an administrative service for The British Crystallographic Association and to facilitate the organisation of scientific meetings – both the Association's annual Spring Meeting and the individual meetings of the four subject groups. We will accept responses in three forms:

- (1) Membership services only
- (2) Spring Meeting event services only
- (3) Membership and Spring Meeting event services

### 1.2.1. Membership Services

The membership management role encompasses: the management of the membership register, including the collation of individual member contact details and subscription fees, and communication with the members via e-mail. The responsibilities are specifically:

- a) Maintaining accurate records and providing updates when requested.

The operation of the membership database should:

- Be accurate and up to date
  - Remain compliant with data protection legislation
  - Include a website to allow users to check, correct, and update their information
  - Allow collection of online payments from members through a simple and accessible system
  - Allow members to securely access documents (e.g. Crystallography News PDF copy)
  - Allow surveys of membership
  - Allow bounced email addresses to be easily identified and immediately brought to the attention of the Officers for action
  - Provide the President with a categorised list of new members and members who have not renewed
  - Allow the President to identify new members so that a welcome email can be sent
- b) Liaison with the printers of Crystallography News in the distribution of annual membership payment notices in both the printed and e-mail distributed electronic versions
- c) Handling direct debits and credit card payments efficiently
- d) Receipting membership payments
- e) Sending out timely reminders for overdue payments
- f) Banking all monies received
- g) Producing membership subscription fee summaries on a 6 monthly basis
- h) Produce summary statistics regarding the diversity of the membership (e.g. age, sex) as requested by the Officers on a 6 monthly basis
- i) Providing lists of the membership of the BCAs individual groups to the Officers if requested.
- j) Administration of bursary award payments

## **Administration**

- k) One member of staff to attend two BCA Council meetings per year.
- l) An electronic copy of an annual activity report should be submitted to Council two weeks prior to the AGM.
- m) Administration of the quarterly members' publication, Crystallography News, in full consultation with the Newsletter Editor and the Newsletter printers, including: securing advertising, invoicing for advertisements, providing membership distribution information to the printer.
- n) Minute taking (optional extra).

## **Marketing**

To be carried out in full consultation with the BCA Council

- a) Marketing.
- b) Co-operation with the BCA in the maintenance of a web site.

Copyright of the image design and web site shall be assigned to the BCA.

### **1.2.2. Annual Meeting and Local Meeting Event Services**

One of the main roles of The British Crystallographic Association is to promote the communication of research in crystallography and structural science. The principal means by which the Association fulfils this role is through the annual Spring Meeting, which is attended by approximately three hundred of its membership and invited participants. The organisation of the scientific aspect of the meeting is handled by a committee composed of members from the sub committees of four individual themed groups and is chaired by an organiser nominated by the Officers from the Association membership.

In the run up to the meeting the successful bidder will liaise with the organising committee and undertake the administrative duties associated with the successful running of the event. These duties will include: assistance in the assessment of the suitability of the facilities of host institutions.

- a) attendance at planning meetings of the committee.
- b) assistance with preparation of conference timetable.
- c) liaison with Local Venue Organiser.
- d) administration of sponsorship.
- e) design and management of print items.
- f) budget preparation and management.
- g) provision of an easily findable website with up-to-date venue and programme information, abstract submission and meeting registration through a simple and efficient portal.

Optional additional services to be charged out at a rate to be agreed are:

- h) administration of abstract/programme book.
- i) production of abstract/programme book electronically: e.g. on usb sticks, website/app.
- j) venue searching.

During the meeting the successful bidder will be expected to perform the following duties:

- a) registration of meeting attendees including the handling of registration details and fees, the booking of accommodation for attendees and the handling of associated charges.
- b) collection of diversity information, as requested by the Officers, during registration and provision of summary statistics of this information following the meeting.
- c) staffing of the registration desk for the duration of the three-day meeting.
- d) assist in the organisation of the manufacturers' exhibition (exhibition sales and management to be approved by the BCA).
- e) Assistance with organising the social programme.
- f) Providing an online survey of delegates immediately after the end of the meeting to assess quality of different aspects of the meeting and to collect ideas to pass on to the next organising committee.
- g) On site staff to a maximum of 4, in agreement with the BCA.

Copyright of all printed material and electronic material belongs to the BCA.

#### **Local One/Two day meetings**

Administrative services as and when required by the Local Organisers.

#### **Marketing**

To be carried out in full consultation with the BCA Council

- a) Marketing.
- b) Co-operation with the BCA in the maintenance of a web site.

Copyright of the image design and web site shall be assigned to the BCA.

## **2. GENERAL CONDITIONS OF THE CONTRACT**

### ***2.1. Basis of the Contract***

Any eventual contract will be based on the following documents:

1. This specification
2. All other documents with this Invitation to Tender.
3. Any amendments to items 1 and 2 issued by The British Crystallographic Association during the tendering period.
4. The bidder's tender proposal.
5. Any post-tender clarifications between the bidder and The British Crystallographic Association

Strict compliance with these contract documents is required unless otherwise specifically agreed in writing.

### ***2.2. Bidder's Responsibilities***

The bidder is responsible for meeting all the requirements of this specification and for all aspects of the fulfilment of the contract.

The bidder will be required to work in close contact with The British Crystallographic Association at all stages of the contract in order to resolve any issues or problems that arise in the most timely and efficient manner.

### ***2.3. Contract Management***

#### **2.3.1. Contract responsible**

At the start of the contract the Bidder shall assign a person who will be responsible for all the reporting to, and contact with The British Crystallographic Association through its officers.

#### **2.3.2. Fulfilment of contract and reporting**

The contract responsible will provide a detailed report in both hardcopy and electronic versions at the Council meeting prior to the Spring Meeting under the headings indicated in sections 1.2.1, 1.2.2 and 1.2.3 as appropriate. Details regarding membership and recruitment should be reported to Council and the chairs of the subject groups as detailed in section 1.2.1.

## **3. TENDERING**

### ***3.1. Contact***

The contact details for tender submission and for any clarifications or queries during the tender process are:

Dr Alexandra Gibbs, BCA President  
E-mail: [tender@crystallography.org.uk](mailto:tender@crystallography.org.uk)

Submission of tenders by email is encouraged.

Responses to clarifications requested before the clarification deadline will be posted on the BCA website at the following link: <http://crystallography.org.uk/tender2026/> and sent to parties who have expressed an interest in bidding by emailing [tender@crystallography.org.uk](mailto:tender@crystallography.org.uk)

### ***3.2. Tender Evaluation***

The British Crystallographic Association will evaluate bids taking into consideration cost, compliance to the contractual obligations and experience of the bidder in conducting similar contracts. The British Crystallographic Association may choose to award two separate contracts for: (a) the membership role outlined in section 1.2.1; and (b) the Administration and Event Organisation remits outlined sections 1.2.2 and 1.2.3. Suppliers should note that the British Crystallographic Association values communication with its members and the recruitment and retention of new members. The British Crystallographic Association will expect suppliers to demonstrate a commitment to these ends in their bid, and weight will be given to bids indicating an incentivised costing structure.

### ***3.3. Information Required with the Tender***

The supplier shall provide with the tender documents sufficient information to allow an informed choice of the supplier as detailed below. It is essential that this information accompanies the tender response. In the absence of this information the bid will be rejected as non-compliant.

#### **3.3.1. Contract Details**

- A confirmation, or otherwise, of every clause of the present specification.
- An outline schedule describing the bidder's capability, and experience, of performing the tasks detailed in this tender document.

#### **3.3.2. Supplier's Details**

- Details of the Quality Assurance scheme that the supplier operates.
- A list of previous, similar, or comparable contracts in size and scope to enable The British Crystallographic Association to assess the Bidder's ability to carry out the contract.
- List of proposed work packages to be undertaken by the bidder.
- A completed Supplier Questionnaire (Appendix A)

### **3.3.3. Cost Breakdown**

A breakdown of costs in the following categories:

- The contract costs of the Membership tasks outlined in 1.2.1
- The contract costs of the Meeting tasks outlined in 1.2.2

Bidders can either provide a categorisation of costs in terms of a flat rate, irrespective of the number of members, or a charge per member, assuming a minimum of 450 members.

### ***3.4. Tender timetable***

The planned timetable is set out below. Dates following the tender submission are indicative and may change due to ongoing negotiations.

- Tender issue 10th September 2026
- Tender clarifications 1st October 2026
- Tender submission 15th October 2026
- Clarification and contract negotiations 16th October-8th December 2026
- Award of contract 8<sup>th</sup> December 2026



# Appendix 1

## SUPPLIER QUESTIONNAIRE FOR COMPANIES SUBMITTING A TENDER RESPONSE

### 1. CONTACT INFORMATION

|                           |  |
|---------------------------|--|
| <b>Company name</b>       |  |
| Address                   |  |
| Registration No.          |  |
| Tel. No.                  |  |
| Fax                       |  |
| Website                   |  |
| <b>Contact Person (1)</b> |  |
| Name                      |  |
| Job Title                 |  |
| Address                   |  |
| Tel No. (direct)          |  |
| Fax                       |  |
| Mobile                    |  |
| Email address             |  |
| <b>Contact Person (2)</b> |  |
| Name                      |  |
| Job Title                 |  |
| Address                   |  |
| Tel No. (direct)          |  |
| Fax                       |  |
| Mobile                    |  |
| Email address             |  |

## 2. BASIC DESCRIPTION

|                                  |  |
|----------------------------------|--|
| Main fields of activity          |  |
| Start up date                    |  |
| No. of employees                 |  |
| Size and location(s) of premises |  |
| Age of premises                  |  |

## 3. TECHNICAL INFORMATION

|                                                                           |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| What percentage of your current capacity would such a contract represent? |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|

|                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Do you operate a QA system? Please provide details. |
|-----------------------------------------------------|

|                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Please provide details of qualifications and experience of key personnel. |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|

Please provide details (including references) of previous similar or comparable projects, in size and scope, to enable the BCA to assess your Company's ability to accomplish the contract.

#### 4. FINANCIAL INFORMATION

|                                                                                                                                |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| Annual turnover for last three years                                                                                           |  |
| Current situation of order book<br>e.g. %age of total capacity already<br>committed for the period of the<br>foreseen contract |  |

|                                                                                                                   |                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Please indicate your willingness to provide copies of your audited accounts for the last three years if requested | <b>Yes / No</b> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|

|                                                                                                   |                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Please provide copies of your public liability insurance and your employer's liability insurance. | <b>Yes / No</b> |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Has your organisation or any directors or partner or any other person who has powers of representation, decision or control been convicted of any of the following offences?</b>                                                                                  | <b>Yes / No</b> |
| (a) conspiracy within the meaning of section 1 or 1A of the Criminal Law Act 1977 where that conspiracy relates to participation in a criminal organisation as defined in Article 2 of Council Framework Decision 2008/841/JHA on the fight against organised crime; |                 |
| (b) corruption within the meaning of section 1 (2) of the Public Bodies Corrupt Practices Act 1889 or section 1 of the Prevention of Corruption Act 1906 (as amended);                                                                                               |                 |
| (c) the offence of bribery;                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                 |
| (d) bribery within the meaning of sections 1,2 or 6 of the Bribery Act 2010 or section 113 of the Representation of the People                                                                                                                                       |                 |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| Act 1983;                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |  |
| (e) fraud, where the offence relates to fraud affecting the financial interests of the European Communities as defined by Article 1 of the Convention relating to the protection of the financial interests of the European Union, within the meaning of: |  |
| (i) the offence of cheating the Revenue;                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |  |
| (ii) the offence of conspiracy to defraud;                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |
| (iii) fraud or theft within the meaning of the Theft Act 1968 and the Theft Act 1978;                                                                                                                                                                     |  |
| (iv) fraudulent trading within the meaning of section 458 of the Companies Act 1985 or section 993 of the Companies Act 2006;                                                                                                                             |  |
| (v) fraudulent evasion within the meaning of section 170 the Customs and Excise Management Act 1979 or section 72 of the Value Added Tax Act 1994;                                                                                                        |  |
| (vi) an offence in connection with taxation in the European Community within the meaning of section 71 of the Criminal Justice Act 1993; or                                                                                                               |  |
| (vii) destroying, defacing or concealing of documents or procuring the extension of a valuable security within the meaning of section 20 of the Theft Act 1968;                                                                                           |  |
| (viii) fraud within the meaning of section 2,3 or 4 of the Fraud Act 2006 or                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| (ix) the possession of articles for use in frauds within the meaning of section 6 of the Fraud Act 2006 or the making, adapting, supplying or offering to supply articles for use in frauds within the meaning of section 7 of that Act;                  |  |
| (f) any offence listed in section 41 of the Counter Terrorism Act 2008 or in Schedule 2 to that Act where the court has determined that there is a terrorist connection                                                                                   |  |
| (g) any offence under sections 44 to 46 of the Serious Crime Act 2007 which relates to an offence covered by subparagraph (f)                                                                                                                             |  |
| (h) money laundering within the meanings of sections 340(11) and 415 of the Proceeds of Crime Act 2002                                                                                                                                                    |  |
| (i) money laundering within the meaning of the Money Laundering Regulations 2003 or Money Laundering Regulations 2007; or                                                                                                                                 |  |

|     |                                                                                                                      |  |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| (j) | any offence in connection with the proceeds of criminal conduct within the meaning of section 93A, 93B or 93C of the |  |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                      |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Criminal Justice Act 1988                                                                                                            |  |
| (k)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | an offence under section 4 of the Asylum and Immigration Act 2004                                                                    |  |
| (l)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | an offence under section 59A of the Sexual Offences Act 2003                                                                         |  |
| (m)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | an offence under section 71 of the Coroners and Justice Act 2009                                                                     |  |
| (n)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | any offence in connection with the proceeds of drug trafficking within the meaning of 49, 50, or 51 of the Drug Trafficking Act 1994 |  |
| (o)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | any offence in connection with slavery and human trafficking within the meaning of the Modern Slavery Act 2015                       |  |
| (p)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | any other offence within the meaning of Article 45(1) of Directive 2004/18/EC as defined by the national law of any relevant State.  |  |
| Environmental Issues:<br>Has your company or any of its directors been convicted of anything relating to any offences listed under administrative law in relation to Directives 2004/17/EC or 2004/18/EC? If yes, please give details |                                                                                                                                      |  |

#### 5. E-MAIL INFORMATION

|                                                          |  |
|----------------------------------------------------------|--|
| Do you have a maximum size for incoming e-mail messages? |  |
| Are you able to receive attachments If so, maximum size? |  |

**Failure to provide all of the requested information and/or documents may affect the evaluation process and could disqualify you from the invitation to tender**

**Completed questionnaire should be returned with your tender**